



EYE ON THE FUTURE Debasish Panda, Chairperson, Irda

seamless delivery of insurance services. It envisages providing an end-to-end experience to prospects and policyholders. It is conceptualised to be a one-stop solution with the facility to purchase, service and settle insurance contracts. It will also enhance digital access and scope for insurance intermediaries and enable assisted purchases to be a very seamless process.

The insights generated by Bima Sugam may lead to more prudent underwriting, information sharing, prevention of mis-selling and fraud. It is an attempt to universalise and democratise insurance and shift it from a push to a pull product. The larger intent is to slowly graduate towards building a financial market infrastructure to be rolled out in phases.

However, to embed insurance in the traditional fabric of the nation, we need brick-and-mortar presence, along with digital inclusion. **To take insurance to each gram panchayat, a tech-led, women-centric**

localised insurance force called Bima Vahak is being conceptualised to distribute multi-line, benefit-based products with parametric triggers, that is, Bima Vistaar, which may greatly enhance accessibility, availability and affordability—which will significantly contribute to insurance penetration.

Q: The insurance regulator is in favour of giving composite licences to insurance companies. How will this affect existing players that have both life and non-life businesses?

A: Granting composite licences is one of the proposals for amendment of the statute. It would enable a one-stop solution for varied insurance needs of citizens. The insurance company would be able to offer multiple types of insurance products, which may lead to economies of scale. This would be beneficial for the policyholders as it may lead to greater affordability